

A This message appears in XP when an MS-DOS or 16-bit application is run. You're probably subsequently prompted to either quit or ignore the error message, and choosing either of these options quits the installation.

The reason for this error could be one or more of the following files being missing or damaged: config.nt, autoexec.nt and/or command.com. To resolve this issue, insert your Windows XP CD in your drive, and open a command prompt. At the prompt, type in the following commands, pressing [Enter] after each command (assuming X is your CD-ROM drive letter).

```
expand X:\i386\config.nt_
%systemroot%\system32\config.nt
expand X:\i386\autoexec.nt_
%systemroot%\system32\autoexec.nt
expand X:\i386\command.co_ %system-
root%\system32\command.com
exit
```

Try running the installation to see if the problem is resolved. If it persists:

1 In Notepad, type in the following:

```
dos=high, umb
device=%systemroot%\system32\
himem.sys
files=40
```

2 Click File > Save As. In the file name dialog box, type in "%systemroot%\system32\config.nt" and click 'Save'.

3 Click File > New. Type the following entries in this new text document:
@echo off

```
lh %systemroot%\system32\mscdexnt.exe
lh %systemroot%\system32\redir
lh %systemroot%\system32\dosx
SET BLASTER=A220 I5 D1 P330 T3
```

4 Click File > Save As, and in the file name dialog box, type in "%systemroot%\system32\autoexec.nt" and click 'Save'.

If the problem is still not resolved, then do the following:

1 Go to Start > Run, type in "%systemroot%\repair" and hit [Enter].

2 We're concerned with two files in this folder: 'Autoexec.nt' and 'Config.nt'. Right-click on the Autoexec.nt file and select 'Copy'.

3 Go to Start > Run, type in "%systemroot%\system32" and hit [Enter].

4 Right-click anywhere in the folder and select 'Paste'.

5 Right-click on the Autoexec.nt file just copied and choose 'Properties'.

6 Select 'Read-only' and click OK.

7 Repeat the above steps for 'Config.nt'.

Activate, Reinstall, Activate, ...

Q Whenever my computer got corrupt beyond repair, I would reinstall the OS. I have a registered version of Windows XP. Once reinstallation is complete, the system asks me to activate Windows. This has become a nuisance because beyond 30 days, it just stops working. Is there anything I can do?

Dr K A Rasheed

A Every single-user licensed edition of Windows XP needs to be activated within 30 days of installation, failing which you will not be able to log into Windows without activation. Re-activation may be necessary when either you re-install Windows or when there are major changes to your computer hardware. Activating Windows XP is very easy, and there are more than one ways to do it. We'll explain two of these.

A. Activating over the Internet:

1 Click on Start, point to All Programs > Accessories > System Tools, and click 'Activate Windows'.

2 Click 'Yes, let's activate Windows over the Internet now'.

3 Click 'Read the Windows Product Activation Privacy Statement', then click 'Back', and then click 'Next'.

4 Click 'No, I don't want to register now; let's just activate Windows' (if you just want to activate Windows) and click 'Next'. The wizard will now establish a connection with the activation server, which will process the activation request.

5 When the activation process is complete, you'll see a message: "You have successfully activated your copy of Windows". Click OK.

B. Activating over the Phone:

This method is useful if you do not have an Internet connection. You'll need to call a Microsoft customer service representative over the phone. The

first step is the same as in the previous method.

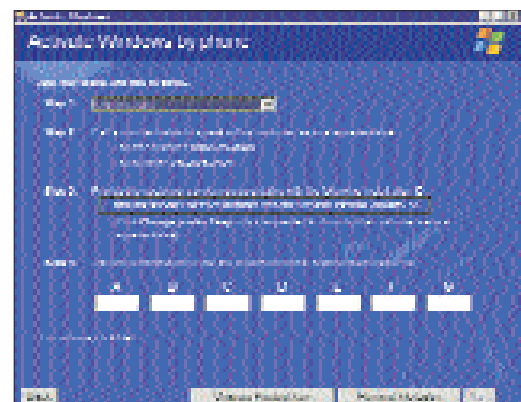
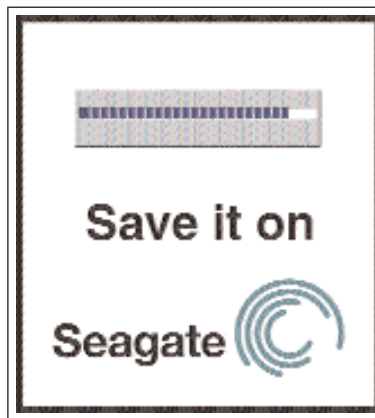
1 Click 'Yes, I want to telephone a customer service representative to activate Windows now'.

2 Repeat the third step from (A) above.

3 Follow the steps in the 'Activate Windows by phone' dialog box, and click 'Next'.

4 Call the toll-free number for your country from the list.

5 An installation ID number will be displayed on the screen, and you need to provide this to the customer service representative, who will return a confirmation ID to you. If you are re-activating, you will have to



Enter the customer ID to activate Windows XP